**Name:** **Roll No:** **Batch:**

## Transitional Words and Phrases

Read each pair of sentences. In each pair, only one word or phrase has changed. Discuss with a partner: What has changed in the relationship between the two ideas?

**Example 1**

A: The college introduced a new attendance policy. As a result, more students started attending classes regularly.

B: The college introduced a new attendance policy. However, more students started attending classes regularly.

Think about it: Do the phrases "as a result" and "however" tell the reader the same thing? What relationship does each one create between the two sentences?

**Example 2**

A: Many students use social media to communicate with their classmates. In addition, they use it to find information about events and opportunities on campus.

B: Many students use social media to communicate with their classmates. For example, they use it to find information about events and opportunities on campus.

Think about it: What do the phrases "in addition" and "for example" tell us? Why would a writer choose one rather than the other?

**Example 3**

Read the paragraph without the words in bold:

Online learning gives students greater flexibility. **However**, it can also create challenges. Students can attend classes from different locations. **For instance**, they can join lectures from home when travelling. **As a result**, online learning can be particularly useful for students who cannot attend classes on campus every day.

Now imagine that the bold words are removed:

Online learning gives students greater flexibility. It can also create challenges. Students can attend classes from different locations. They can join lectures from home when travelling.

Online learning can be particularly useful for students who cannot attend classes on campus every day.

Which version is easier to follow? Why? So, what are these words doing?

Words and phrases such as **however**, **in addition**, **for example**, **as a result**, **first**, **finally**, **therefore**, and **on the other hand** help readers understand how one idea is connected to another. These are called **transitional words and phrases**. They guide the reader through a piece of writing by showing relationships such as sequence, addition, contrast, example, cause and effect, and conclusion.

In the exercises that follow, you will practise identifying, choosing, and using transitional words and phrases to make your writing clearer and easier to follow.

- Transitional words and phrases provide connections between sentences and between paragraphs.
- Skillful use of transitional words and phrases makes a paragraph coherent and there is a smooth transition from one idea to another.
- These words help to retain continuity in thoughts and ideas in a paragraph.

**Exercise 1:** Join the sentences by using proper transitional phrase(s) to form one meaningful sentence.

1. The car was recalled. There was a design fault.

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2. The jute factory was forced to close. Sales were declining rapidly.

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3. The fire started at the weekend. The office was empty, no one was hurt.

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4. There is a recession. Most retailers have recorded a sharp fall in profits.

5. Several economists have recommended a cut in interest rates. This may cause inflation.

6. A recent article has suggested that one procedure to cut the deficit is for the president to reduce the federal budget. It also claims that federal, state, and local taxes should be lowered.

7. Rising wages are possibly one of the primary causes of inflation. More evidence is needed to support this claim.

8. In physics, the weight of an object is the gravitational force with which the Earth attracts it. If a man weighs 150 pounds, this means that Earth pulls him down with a force of 150 pounds.

9. There were a large number of people who opposed Heathrow's expansion plans. They were ignored in the final consultation.

10. Polls show that Tony Blair is the most popular Prime Minister this century. There are even members of his own party who are uneasy with his approach.

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11. There are some slight variations in temperature. 26 to 29ºC should be expected.

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12. There are two main Channel Islands. They are Jersey and Guernsey. They are much closer to France than to England.

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13. Sales of CDs have experienced a small but steady fall over the past 12 months. Vinyl records have seen an increase in their share of the market, up to 1.7%.

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14. It is clear that the situation in Brazil will improve only slowly. The outlook is slightly more optimistic given the economic problems being experienced in Japan.

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15. In order to try to reduce car use in the inner cities, the government has announced new restrictions on company parking spaces. There is a new tax on individual car use.

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**Exercise 2:** The paragraph below has been broken into simple sentences. The ideas are related, but the sentences are not connected. Combine the sentences using appropriate transitional words or phrases to create a well-organised paragraph.

**Preparing for a holiday**

There are many things we can do to get ready for a holiday. Checking your passport is one of the most important things to do. Nothing ruins pre-holiday excitement like realising that you cannot find your passport. An expired passport can also cause serious problems. You should check your passport several months before you travel. You should make sure that you have all the essential documents for your trip. These documents may include entry visas, your driving licence, your boarding pass, and your hotel confirmation. You should put all these documents together in a plastic folder.

You should also find out your luggage allowance before you travel. Over-packing can cause problems at the check-in desk. Bags that are too heavy can start your holiday badly. You may have to move some of the weight into your hand luggage. You may have to pay extra if you cannot reduce the weight. You should weigh your case before you leave. You should also

consider home security before you go. Nothing will end a post-holiday high like returning home to discover that your house has been broken into. You should double-check that all doors and windows are locked. You can ask a trusted neighbour to check on your house regularly. Your neighbour can also remove any mail from behind your front door. You should check your route to the airport. You should pre-book a parking space if necessary. You should listen to the radio for traffic alerts before you set off.